

CARLOS BUENO MARTINEZ

EDUCATION POLICY RESEARCHER

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SUMMARY

Education policy researcher and PhD Candidate with over five years of experience contributing to international education initiatives. Proven track record in leading large scale and comparative education research projects, supporting education policy analysis, capacity development processes and M&E initiatives. Specialized in a wide range of educational planning domains, including school choice, school leadership, dropout prevention and curriculum reform. Experienced researcher with strong mix methods background and skilled in translating research into actionable insights. Committed to strengthening education systems by bridging research, policy, and practice.

CORE SKILLS

- Education Policy Analysis and Research Management
- Quantitative, Geospatial, Econometric and Impact Evaluation Research
- Large-Scale Data Management and Analysis
- Mixed Methods Research and Implementation Research

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)

Prospective Short-term Summer Fellow (Education Division)

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

Washington DC – USA

- Strengthening data infrastructure and reproducibility of the CIMA education indicators platform through the optimization of R and Stata workflows for large-scale assessments and harmonized household survey data.
- Develop and support GitHub-based reproducible data pipelines, automated processing workflows, and policy-oriented briefs of educational indicators across Latin America and the Caribbean.

Autonomous University of Barcelona – GEPS Research Group

PhD Candidate and Project Researcher

Feb 2024 – Present

Barcelona – Spain

- Developing a mix methods PhD thesis on multidimensional and geospatial approaches for planning educational access in secondary schools in the cities of Bogotá and Medellín (Colombia).
- Conducting econometric and geospatial analyses of school supply and demand, spatial accessibility, school choice behavior and socio-spatial segregation patterns using EMIS, Census, and Survey data.

UNICEF Innocenti – Data Must Speak (DMS) Project

Education Research Consultant

April 2023 – April 2024

Florence – Italy

- Led the design of Phase 4 of the DMS research initiative, integrating insights from scaling, implementation, and behavioral sciences to identify conditions for replicating effective school practices in LMICs.
- Conducted in-depth qualitative research in Zambia (interviews and document reviews) and developed policy-relevant technical briefs and workshops with the Ministry of Education on school leadership.

Bofill Foundation – Regional Think Tank focused on education inequalities

Education Policy Researcher and Data Analyst

Aug 2022 – Dec 2024

Barcelona – Spain

- Led a two-year research project on School Dropout in Secondary Education and TVET in Catalonia through the design and execution of quantitative and econometric analyses using large-scale EMIS education data.
- Produced two influential policy reports and developed outreach strategies and products that gained recognition from education stakeholders and media outlets to inform public discourse and policymaking.

Education Cannot Wait (ECW) – UN Global Fund for Education in Emergencies

Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Officer

Feb 2022 – Jul 2022

Geneva - Switzerland

- Supported ECW's 2021 *Annual Results Report* by conducting data quality checks, harmonizing grantee datasets, performing quantitative analyses and drafting sections on access, financing and quality of education.
- Liaised with and supported grantees across English, Spanish and French-Speaking countries to address data discrepancies and improve M&E reporting standards.

UNESCO – International Bureau of Education (UNESCO-IBE)

Project Consultant

May 2021 - Jan 2022

Geneva - Switzerland

- Coordinated Capacity Development projects focused on curriculum reform for Ministries of Education in The Gambia and South Sudan.
- Led the design and management of a diverse Research and Development (R&D) portfolio across countries, covering Global Citizenship Education, Hybrid Education, Inclusive Education, and Curriculum Reform.

Miami University

Graduate and Research Assistant

Aug 2019 – Jun 2020

Oxford - USA

- Conducted literature reviews and coordinated projects within the Department of Educational Psychology as a Research Assistant (RA), contributing to academic publications and presentations.
- Facilitated graduate-level instruction as a Teaching Assistant (TA) for “EDP 666: Educational Consultation, Collaboration, and Community Psychology” and “EDP 650: Diversity in School Psychology.”

Neurodiversity Belgium

Policy and Advocacy Intern

Jun 2018 – Sep 2018

Brussels - Belgium

- Supported the provision of psychoeducation, workshops and advocacy events at the EU level for families, teachers and professionals with children with disabilities.
- Led a systematic research review on reasonable accommodations for ADHD and the inclusiveness of the Belgian educational system in preparation of a national survey for *ADHD-Europe*.

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate – Education Policy

Autonomous University of Barcelona (GEPS Research group)

Feb 2024 – Present

Barcelona - Spain

- Granted “La Caixa INPhINIT Retaining Fellowship” for PhD studies.
- Coursework: Essex University - *Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation, Machine Learning for Social Scientists, Spatial Econometrics*. Charles University - *Spatial Data Science in Python*.

Erasmus Mundus Master (M.A.) - Education Policies for Global Development

Autonomous University of Barcelona, University of Glasgow and Cyprus University

Sep 2020 – Sep 2022

ES, UK, CY

- Granted a full Erasmus Mundus Scholarship for Graduate Studies (Graduated with Merit).

Master of Science (M.S.) - School Psychology

Miami University

Aug 2019 – Jun 2020

Oxford - USA

- Granted a full Graduate Assistantship Scholarship (Graduated with 4.00/4.00 GPA).

Bilingual Bachelor's Degree - Psychology

Universidad Complutense de Madrid

Sep 2015 – Jun 2019

Madrid - Spain

- Undertook a one-year Erasmus Study at KU Leuven (Belgium) in September 2017.
- Graduated with 6 merit distinctions. Conducted qualitative research as part of the thesis on Bullying of Autistic Children in Mainstream schools in Madrid.

LANGUAGES

- **Spanish:** Native speaker.
- **English:** C2 Proficiency (+5 years of studies and professional experience) with the following qualifications:
TOEFL Certificate - Overall score (107): Reading (27), Listening (28), Speaking (29), Writing (23).
Graduate Record Examination (GRE) - Verbal (61st percentile), Quantitative (p74), Writing (p82).
- **French:** Intermediate B1-B2.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Digital & Data Analysis Skills:** RStudio (Advanced), QGIS (Advanced), NVivo (Advanced), Python (Intermediate), STATA (Intermediate), ArcGIS (Intermediate), SPSS (Intermediate), GitHub (Intermediate).
- **Office Skills:** Word (Advanced), Excel (Advanced), PowerPoint (Advanced), Outlook (Advanced).

PUBLICATIONS

- Bonal, X., González, S., & **Bueno, C.** (2025, under review). *Do gentrifiers fly from local schools? The case of Barcelona*.
- Zancajo, A., & **Bueno, C.** (2024). *L'abandonament a l'educació postobligatòria [School Dropout in Upper Secondary Education in Catalonia]*. Fundació Jaume Bofill.
- **Bueno, C.**, & Bergmann, J. (2024, unpublished). *Strengthening the instructional leadership role of school leaders in Zambia*. UNICEF-Innocenti Technical Brief.
- Zancajo, A., & **Bueno, C.** (2023). *L'abandonament a 4t d'ESO: les desigualtats en la transició a l'educació postobligatòria [School dropout in the transition from lower to upper secondary education in Catalonia]*. Fundació Jaume Bofill.
- **Bueno, C.**, & Bonal, X. (2023). Fragmented spaces in the urban landscape: A socio-spatial analysis of educational supply in the city of Madrid. *British Educational Research Journal*, 49(5), 1108-1132.
- **Bueno, C.**, Opertti, R., & Arsendeau, P. (2021). Curriculum as the Spirit and Subject Matter of Education. In *Curriculum On The Move*. UNESCO-IBE: Geneva.
- Opertti, R., **Bueno, C.** & Arsendeau, P. (2021). Inclusion in Education. In *Curriculum On The Move*. UNESCO-IBE: Geneva.
- Sabnis, S., & **Bueno, C.** (2020). Disability Critical Race Theory. In Proctor, S. L., & Rivera, D. P. (Eds). *Critical Theories for School-Based Practice: A Foundation for Equity and Inclusion in Practice and Supervision*.

CONFERENCES

- Bonal, X., **Bueno, C.**, Gonzalez, S. (2024). *The effects of gentrification on educational mobility: The case of Barcelona*. Working paper presented for the Fritz Thyssen Foundation. Cologne, Germany.
- **Bueno, C.**, & Bonal, X. (2022). *Fragmented spaces in the urban landscape: A socio-spatial analysis of the local education markets in the city of Madrid*. Working paper presented as part of the REFORMED conference.
- Moderated two UNESCO-IBE/OECD Webinars on Curriculum Transformation and Curriculum Overload.
- **Bueno, C.** (2019). *Bullying among children with Autism: understanding its mechanisms and developing potential interventions*. Poster presented in the Graduate Research Forum (GRF) at Miami University, USA.
- **Bueno, C.** (2018). *Autism Spectrum Condition: Special Needs and Educational System functioning in Spain*. Posters presented in the 10th Annual Bilingual ADHD-ASC-Dyslexia Awareness Conference, Brussels, BE.

VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCES

- Assistant in the World Brain Day: "Brain & Mental Health Awareness Across the Lifespan" - July, 2020.
- Talawanda day: leader of a mental health counseling group for high school students. Oxford, OH (USA).
- Basketball coach and summer camp monitor in Madrid (Spain) – from 2014 to 2019.
- Collaboration in an educational refugee project at Serve the City in Brussels (Belgium) – February 2018.
- Collaboration with Angelman's Syndrome Association (ASA) in Madrid (Spain) – September 2017.
- Collaboration with Psycho-pedagogical Association of Autism (PAUTA) in Madrid (Spain) – August 2017.